

Beshkal (Бешкал): An Uzbek Clan/Tribal Subdivision — Comprehensive Research Report

TL;DR

Beshkal (Бешкал) is a genuine, verifiable Uzbek clan-subdivision name (an urug'/tarmoq), most often attested as a branch of the Mang'it (Мангыт) urug' — one of the "92 o'zbek urug'i" — and it survives today as the name of at least five distinct mapped settlements in the Qashqadaryo, Jizzax and Samarqand regions of Uzbekistan.

The clan placement is **contested between three scholarly traditions**: S. Qorayev (2009) lists *beshkal* as a subdivision of the **Mang'it**; the toponymist Eldar Asanov reports *beshkal/kallar* as a clan of the **kaltatoy** tribe within the **turk** ethnic group; and an academic yuz-clan study places a *Beshkal* under the **yuz** clan's *so'loqli* branch. All agree it is a minor Uzbek tribal ("besh-" + "kal") ethnonym.

Beyond the ethnonym, Beshkal is a mapped populated place near Kitob (Qashqadaryo, ~7,900 people per GeoNames-derived data) and a village name in G'allaorol (Jizzax) and Bulung'ur/Ishtixon/Oqdaryo (Samarqand); the precise meaning of the second element "-kal" is **not resolved in any dictionary found**, and there is **no DNA, census, or genealogy-community data** specific to Beshkal.

Key Findings

1. Beshkal is a real Uzbek clan name (well corroborated)

Multiple independent sources — scholarly, journalistic, and government/administrative — confirm that Beshkal is an Uzbek clan (urug') name that became a place name:

Scholarly (Uzbek): An article in *Science and Innovation* (Vol. 1, Issue 8, 2022), quoting toponymist **S. Qorayev (2009, p. 59)**, lists the Mang'it subdivisions verbatim as: "...gaulak, ko'sa, toz, qorabayir, baqiri, kula tang'ali, mang'it qozoq, o'n ikki, cho'qay, galabotir, **beshkal**, chobakchak, uz, uvolay kabi urug'larga bo'lingan» [Qorayev, 2009: 59]." (scientists.uz)

Journalistic (Uzbek): The Samarqand regional paper *Zarafshon* (zarnews.uz, 19 Oct 2022), in an article by Murodqosim Abdiyev (member of the regional toponymic commission), states plainly: "Quljamon, Beshkal o'zbek urug'larining nomi. Qadimda mazkur hududda o'sha urug' vakillari yashagan" ("Quljamon and Beshkal are names of Uzbek clans; in the past representatives of that clan lived in this area"). [Zarnews](#)

[Zarnews](#)

Administrative/academic (Uzbek): The Jizzax State Pedagogical Institute toponymy monograph (ziyonet.uz) lists *kallar*, *beshkal* (G'allaorol district) among settlement names that are "in fact names of minor ethnic units (clans)." [Ziyonet](#)

[Ziyonet](#)

2. Clan placement — a genuine scholarly disagreement

Mang'it placement (Qorayev 2009): Beshkal sits at the level of a subdivision within Mang'it, grouped around Jizzax alongside oq/qora/ala mang'it, temirxo'ja, ko'sa, toz, o'n ikki, cho'qay, etc. In our urug' → aymoq → tarmoq hierarchy, Mang'it is the **urug'**; its three classic aymoqs are **To'q-mang'it, Oq-mang'it, Qora-mang'it** (per uz.wikipedia and the Zaki Validiy summary). A Voronovskiy-based Russian source gives fuller sub-

structure — "тук-мангыты (их деления: султан, кузы-кучкар, кукалдор, карасар); тимур ходжа, баурдак-мангыт, уч-уруг мангыты (их деления: исабай, купак, бай деганди); кара-мангыт..." and notes the Uzbek Mang'it numbered some **120,000 families in the early 19th century**. Qorayev's flat list does not explicitly nest beshkal under one of the three aymoqs, so whether beshkal is an aymoq-level or tarmoq-level unit is left unspecified. [Wikipedia](#)

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Kaltatoy/turk placement (Asanov): Eldar Asanov's toponymics essay (aniq.uz; originally *Oila davrasida*, No. 6, 11 Feb 2016) states verbatim: "Beshkal, kallar – turk ittifoqiga kiruvchi kaltatoy qabilasining bir urug'i. U kattakallar va maydakallar to'plariga bo'linadi. ...Rabotak arablarining bir guruhi o'zlarini beshkal urug'iga mansub deb hisoblaganlar, qo'ng'irotlarda esa kallar degan to'p bo'lgan." That is: Beshkal/kallar is a clan of the **kaltatoy** tribe of the **turk** ethnic group; it divides into *kattakallar* ("big kals") and *maydakallar* ("small kals"); some **Rabotak Arabs** claimed beshkal affiliation, and the **Qo'ng'iro**t had a *kallar* sub-group. The "turk" ethnic group here is the recognized one that, per uz.wikipedia ("Turk (etnik guruh)"), "4 yirik qabila (turk, musobozori, kaltatoy va barlos)dan iborat bo'lgan" — comprising four major tribes: turk, musobozori, kaltatoy, and barlos.

Yuz placement (Doniyorov/Maksheev): An academic article on the yuz clan in the Jizzax valley (inlibrary.uz) lists "Beshkal" as a component of the **So'loqli** branch (alongside Kultepalik, G'afur, Chirqirovuq, Mirza, Ariq, Beklar to'pi). [Inlibrary](#)

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Interpretation: These are not necessarily contradictory. The recurrence of "beshkal/kallar" across Mang'it, kaltatoy/turk, yuz, Qo'ng'iro

3. A likely primary-source attestation: "пиш-кул" (Voronovskiy 1947)

The Russian Wikipedia article "Мангыты (узбеки)" lists the kara-mangyt subdivisions as "чауки, ун-икки, куса, бакирчи, кула-тамгали, парча, кара, таза, **пиш-кул**." The footnote for that sentence is **D. G. Voronovskiy, "Gulshan al-mulk" of Muhammad Yakub Bukhari (Candidate dissertation, Tashkent, 1947), pp. 208-210** — NOT Karmysheva. (The identical passage with the same citation is mirrored on secondary sites such as works.doklad.ru.) Because Qorayev's Uzbek list of the same subdivisions has *beshkal* precisely where the Russian list has *пиш-кул* (pish-kul), and the other names line up almost one-to-one (cho'qay=чауки, o'n ikki=ун-икки, ko'sa=куса, baqiri=бакирчи, kula tamg'ali=кула-тамгали, toz/taza=таза), **пиш-кул is very likely a Russian rendering of Beshkal/Beshkul**. This is a strong inference, not a directly sourced identity — the Voronovskiy primary text was consulted only via the Wikipedia footnote and its mirror. [Wikipedia](#)

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[Wikipedia](#)

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4. Etymology — partially resolved

besh = Turkic "five" (transparent; the same element appears in beshbola, beshkaltak, beshkapa, beshkubi, beshog'och, beshsari, beshtentak, beshqozon, beshkal — per the Bukhara-microtoponyms article on ResearchGate).

-kal: No consulted dictionary gives an explicit gloss. The best evidence (Asanov) is that "kal" is a productive ethnonymic root here — the same root yields *kallar*, *kattakallar*, *maydakallar*. The user's candidate meanings (kal = "bald/mangy"; qal = "fortress/stay"; kala = "cattle"; kal as a personal name) **could not be**

confirmed for this specific name. Report as unresolved. (The Nafasov/Nafasova *O'quv izohli lug'ati* on ziyouz.com has entries for neighboring "besh-" names — e.g. BESHKALTAK "qo'ng'iro't, kenagas, qatag'on, qipchoqlarning urug'i," and BESHKUBI as a tarmoq of the xitoy-yuz — but no standalone "Beshkal" headword was located.)

5. Geography — Beshkal as a place name (multiple distinct locations)

Qashqadaryo (near Kitob): GeoNames-derived data (getamap.net) lists "Besh-Kal (Beshkal)" as a populated place at **39°15'N, 67°03'E, elev. 924 m, population 7,914**, ~10 km from Kitob. This is the largest and best-geocoded Beshkal. [getamap](#)

Jizzax / G'allaorol: Confirmed as a clan-derived settlement name in G'allaorol district (Jizzax toponymy monograph, ziyonet.uz).

Samarqand / Bulung'ur: A "Beshkal qishlog'i" in Bulung'ur district appears in a 2023 state-property auction notice (natlib.uz), tied to "Samarqand-Bulung'ur elita urug'chilik xo'jaligi." [Natlib](#)

Samarqand / Ishtixon (Sherqo'rg'on QFY): "Beshkal" is item 2 in the Sherqo'rg'on rural citizens' assembly geographic-objects list (samarkand.uz). [Samarkand](#)

Samarqand / Oqdaryo (Olchintepa MFY): The Olchintepa mahalla page (sammahalla.uz) states: "'Beshkal' qishlog'ining nomi o'zbek urug'larining biri - beshkal urug'ning nomidan kelib chiqqan" ("The village Beshkal's name derives from one of the Uzbek clans, the beshkal clan"). [Sammahalla](#)

6. Gaps — where nothing was found

DNA/Y-haplogroup: No study, FamilyTreeDNA project entry, or Molgen thread names Beshkal specifically. (General Uzbek/Kazakh clan Y-DNA studies exist but do not break out beshkal.)

Census: No 1897, 1926, or Soviet census record specifically tabulating "Beshkal" was located.

Genealogy communities: No self-identifying Beshkal Telegram/Facebook/YouTube community content was found; the topic appears only inside general "92 o'zbek urug'i" material.

7. Disambiguation (unrelated homonyms)

Turkic "Besh-/Beş-" ("five") place names elsewhere (Besh-Burkan in Kyrgyzstan, Besh-Ozyok in Altai, Beshtau in Russia, Bishkazi in Bashkortostan) are **unrelated** structurally to the specific compound Beshkal.

Indian/Sanskrit "Bishkal/Beshkal" and the Turkish surname "Beşkal" are **unrelated** to the Uzbek clan.

Details

Terminology. Using the agreed hierarchy urug' (clan) → aymoq (major division) → tarmoq (branch): the Mang'it is an **urug'**; its three classic **aymoqs** are To'q-mang'it, Oq-mang'it, Qora-mang'it. Beshkal is best described as a **tarmoq** (branch/lineage) — under Qorayev it is one of many Mang'it subdivisions; under Asanov it is an urug' of the kaltatoy qabila that itself has *to'p* sub-groups (kattakallar, maydakallar). The sources do not agree on the exact tier, which is itself a finding: minor lineage names like Beshkal float between tiers depending on the classifier.

Source-quality tiering.

(a) *Academic/scholarly*: Qorayev 2009 (via scientists.uz); the Jizzax Ped. Institute monograph (ziyonet.uz); the yuz-clan article (inlibrary.uz); the Bukhara microtoponyms article (ResearchGate); Nafasov/Nafasova

dictionary (ziyouz.com). Voronovskiy 1947 is a primary scholarly dissertation but consulted only via the Russian Wikipedia footnote and a mirror.

(b) *Journalistic*: zarnews.uz (2022); aniq.uz reproducing Asanov's newspaper essay (2016/2018).

(c) *User-generated/administrative*: getamap.net (GeoNames mirror), samarkand.uz, sammahalla.uz, natlib.uz auction notice, uz.wikipedia/ru.wikipedia.

(d) *Gaps*: DNA, census, genealogy communities.

Conflicts explicitly noted. (i) Clan parent: Mang'it (Qorayev) vs. kaltatoy/turk (Asanov) vs. yuz/so'loqli (Doniyorov). (ii) The user's premise that the kara-mangyt list comes from Karmysheva (1976) is **incorrect** for the inline citation — the Russian Wikipedia footnote is Voronovskiy 1947, pp. 208–210 (Karmysheva appears only in the general bibliography).

Recommendations

To pin down clan tier and parent: consult the primary texts directly — S. Qorayev, *O'zbekiston viloyatlari toponimlari* (2005) and his 2009 work p. 59; B.Kh. Karmysheva, *Очерки этнической истории южных районов Таджикистана и Узбекистана* (1976); and especially **D. G. Voronovskiy's 1947 dissertation, pp. 208–210**, to confirm whether "пиш-кул" = Beshkal. These are library-only; the online trail ends at secondary quotation.

To confirm geography/demography: query the Uzbek statistics agency SOATO/MHOBT classification (stat.uz) and the G'allaorol/Bulung'ur hokimlik and mahalla registries for the exact administrative status and current population of each Beshkal. Benchmark: if a Beshkal appears in the official SOATO list with a code, it is a currently recognized settlement; if not, it may have been renamed (the renaming debate is live — see zarnews/aniq).

To fill the DNA gap: if a family-history angle matters, recruit self-identified Beshkal men into the FamilyTreeDNA "Uzbek" project; there is currently no beshkal-specific Y-DNA data, so any result would be novel.

Threshold to change conclusions: direct sight of Voronovskiy 1947 confirming пиш-кул→Beshkal would upgrade the Mang'it/kara-mangyt placement from "likely" to "documented"; a SOATO entry would upgrade the settlement claims from mixed-source to official.

Caveats

The precise **meaning of "-kal" is undocumented**; do not assert "five bald men" or similar without a dictionary source — none was found.

The **пиш-кул = Beshkal** identification is a well-reasoned inference, not a sourced fact.

getamap.net population/coordinate figures derive from the GeoNames dataset and older topographic sources; treat the 7,914 figure and 924 m elevation as approximate and undated.

Multiple distinct places named Beshkal exist; claims about "the" Beshkal settlement must specify region (Qashqadaryo/Kitob vs. Jizzax/G'allaorol vs. Samarqand districts).

Some corroborating pages (samarkand.uz, sammahalla.uz, natlib.uz) are administrative/user-generated and were not cross-checked against primary cadastral records.

Source List (with working links)

S. Qorayev (2009) quoted in *Science and Innovation* Vol. 1 Issue 8, 2022 — Uzbek —

<https://scientists.uz/fileView.php?id=2829>

Zarafshon / zarnews.uz, "Quljamon, Beshkal xunuk nom emas...", 19 Oct 2022 — Uzbek — <https://zarnews.uz/uz/post/quljamon-beshkal-xunuk-nom-emas-ozbek-uruglarining-nomi-qotirbuluq-esa-shifobaxsh-buloq-bor-joy-degani>

Eldar Asanov, "Qosh qo'yaman deb ko'z chiqarmaylik yoxud joy nomlari nega xunuk?", aniq.uz (orig. *Oila davrasida* No. 6, 11 Feb 2016) — Uzbek — <https://aniq.uz/uz/yangiliklar/qosh-quyaman-deb-kuz-chiqarmaylik-yoxud-joy-nomlari-nega-xunuk>

Jizzax State Pedagogical Institute, Jizzax province toponymy (2013) — Uzbek — <https://api.ziyounet.uz/uploads/books/251467/5b3335c69e631.pdf>

"Мангыты (узбеки)", Russian Wikipedia (kara-mangyt list; footnote = Voronovskiy 1947, pp. 208-210) — Russian — [https://ru.wikipedia.org/wiki/Мангыты_\(узбеки\)](https://ru.wikipedia.org/wiki/Мангыты_(узбеки))

"O'zbek urug'lari", Uzbek Wikipedia (Mang'it three aymoqs; 92 urug' framework) — Uzbek — https://uz.wikipedia.org/wiki/O'zbek_urug'lari

N. Adizova, "Mikrotoponimlar tasnifi (Buxoro viloyati misolida)" (besh- name family incl. beshkal) — Uzbek — https://www.researchgate.net/publication/360280030_Mikrotoponimlar_tasnifi_Buxoro_viloyati_misolida

T. Nafasov, V. Nafasova, *O'zbek tili toponimlarining o'quv izohli lug'ati* (2007) — Uzbek — [https://ziyouz.com/books/lugatlar/O'zbek%20tili%20toponimlarining%20o'quv%20izohli%20lug'ati%20\(T.Nafasov,%20V.Nafasova\).pdf](https://ziyouz.com/books/lugatlar/O'zbek%20tili%20toponimlarining%20o'quv%20izohli%20lug'ati%20(T.Nafasov,%20V.Nafasova).pdf)

Yuz-clan in the Jizzax valley (Beshkal in So'loqli branch; Doniyorov/Maksheev), inlibrary.uz — Uzbek — <https://inlibrary.uz/index.php/new-uzbekistan/article/view/32181>

"Besh-Kal (Beshkal) – Qashqadaryo" (GeoNames-derived: 39.25N, 67.05E, pop 7,914), getamap.net — English — [https://www.getamap.net/maps/uzbekistan/uzbekistan_\(general\)/_beshkal/](https://www.getamap.net/maps/uzbekistan/uzbekistan_(general)/_beshkal/)

Samarqand region geographic-objects list (Beshkal in Sherqo'rg'on QFY, Ishtixon; and Bulung'ur listings) — Uzbek — https://samarkand.uz/about_region/viloyatdagi-geografik-obektlar

Oqdaryo tumani, Olchintepa MFY (Beshkal village from beshkal clan), sammahalla.uz — Uzbek — <http://tizim.sammahalla.uz/mfy/view/583>

Kaltatoy tribe / turk group context (shosh.uz) — Uzbek — <https://shosh.uz/shayxontohur-dahasi-qashqar-qiyot-qoryog-di-mahallalari/>

N. V. Khanykov, *Описание Бухарского ханства* (1843; lists ~97 Uzbek clans), vostlit — Russian — <https://www.vostlit.info/Texts/rus4/Hanykov1/pred.htm>